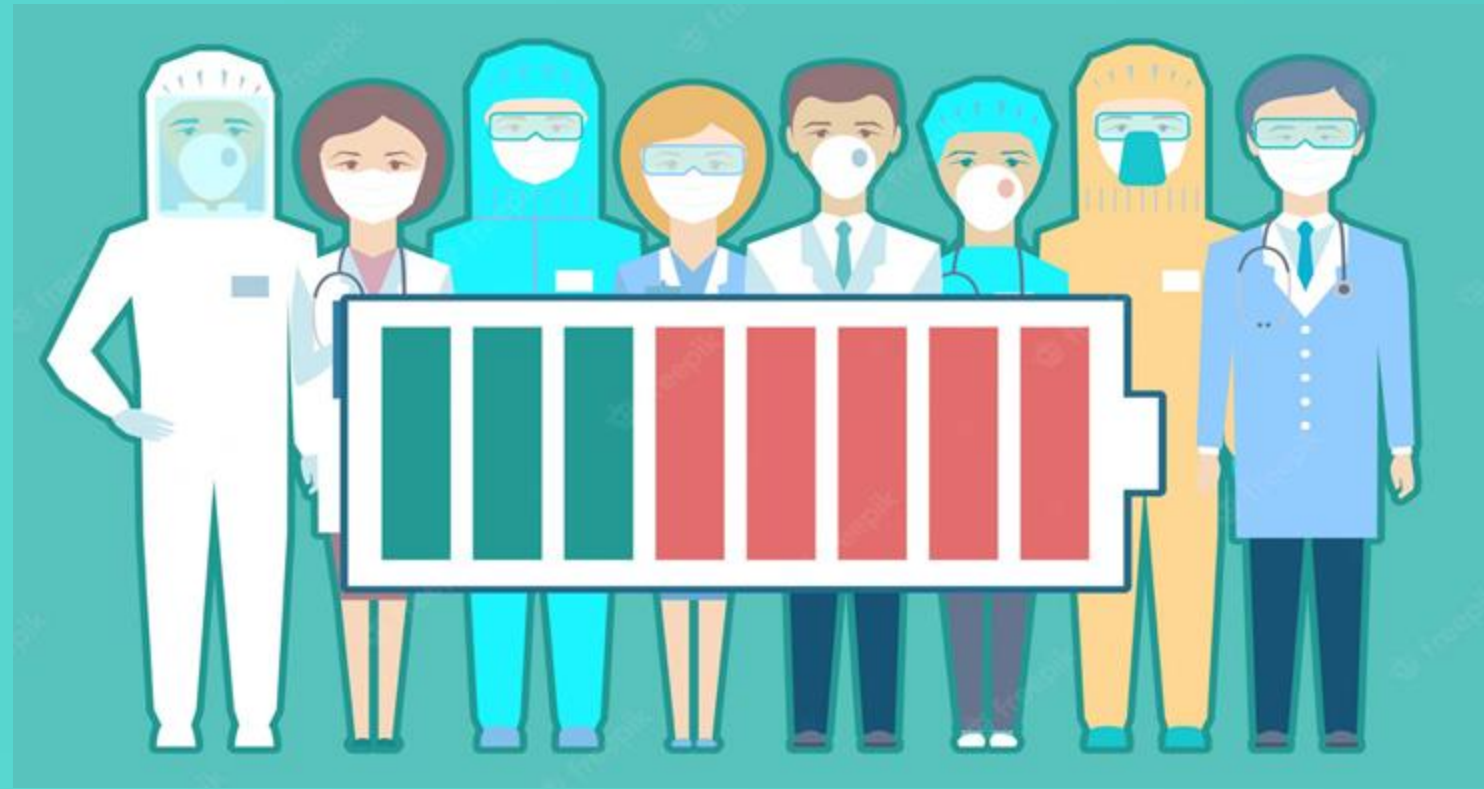




BurnEDout



Self-perceived burnout in Emergency Department Nurses in the post-post pandemic period: a cross-sectional study

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Background

Emergency department nurses are at high risk of burnout, this has been notably exacerbated by the COVID-19 pandemic.

However, there is currently little research on how emergency department nurses perceive their own level of burnout in the time-period following the pandemic.

It has been widely observed that pressures on emergency departments across the country have increased following the pandemic, with increased demand for services and staffing shortfalls.

Work related stress, burnout and poor mental health are well known key contributors to high staff attrition rate in the emergency department.

The purpose of this study is to examine the self-perception of burnout for emergency department nurses in the period following the COVID-19 pandemic.

Methodology

Study design:

The data were collected using a survey website, all responses were voluntary and anonymised
Time scale: 1st May - 1st June 2022

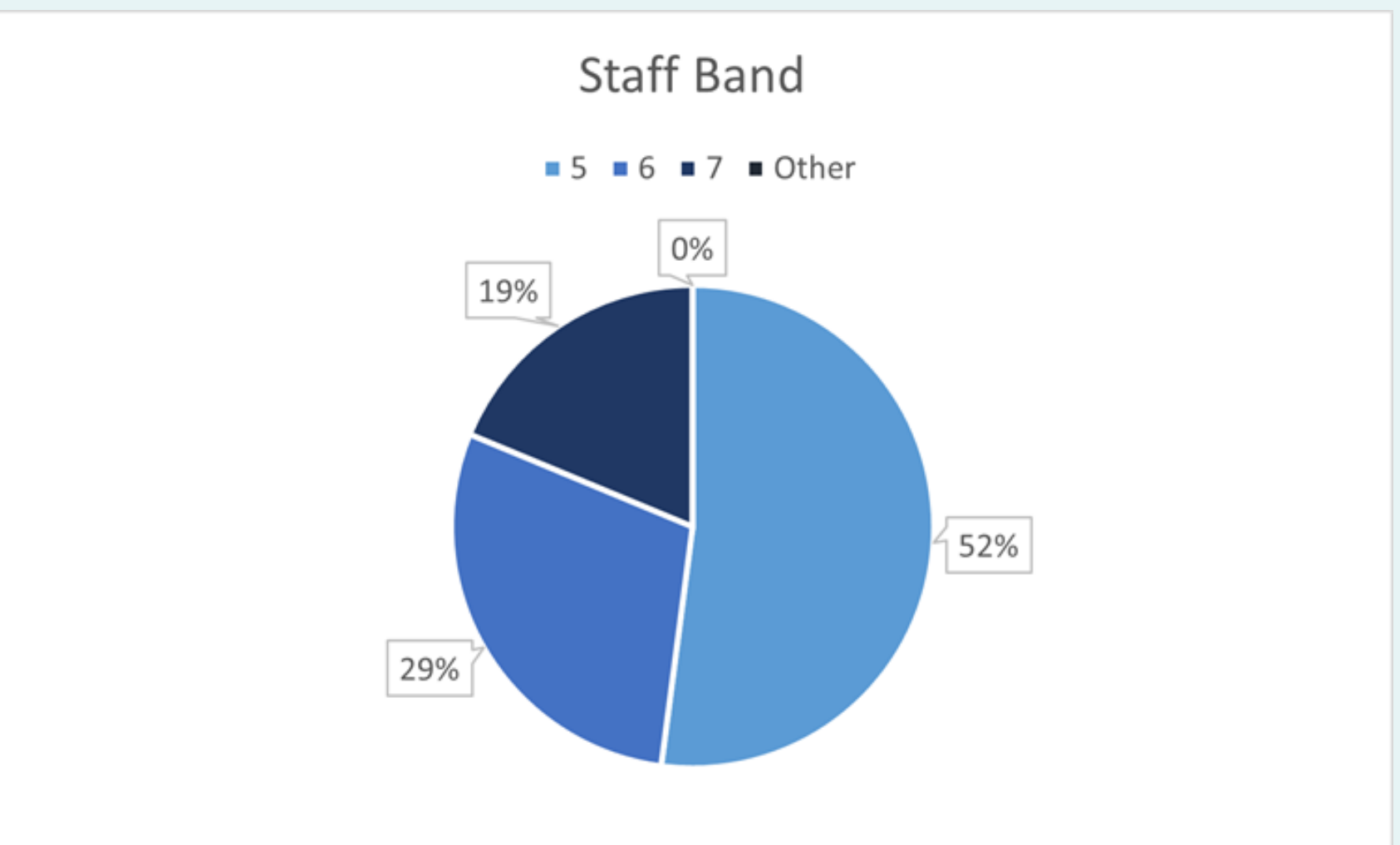
Participants and sampling:

Participants: n=48 Registered Nurses working within Addenbrooke’s Hospital Emergency Department

Recruitment: Link to the survey website distributed through trust email and social media

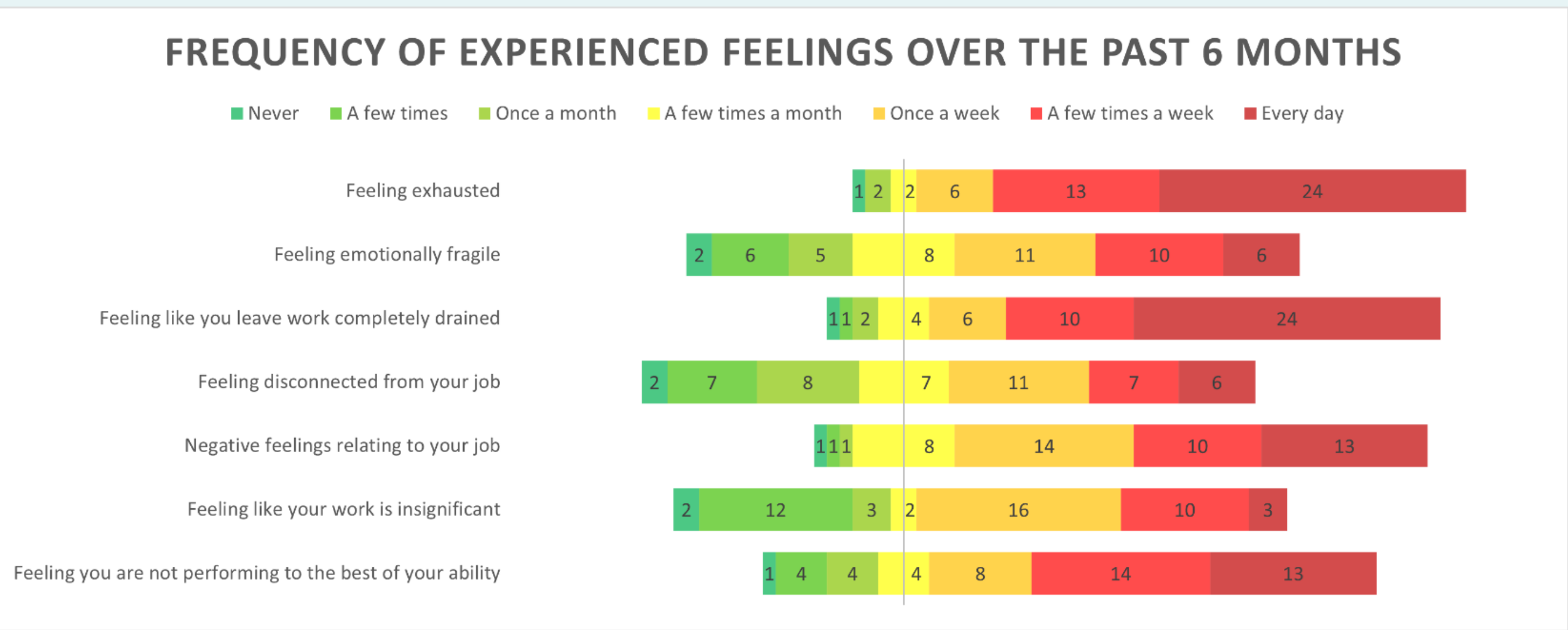
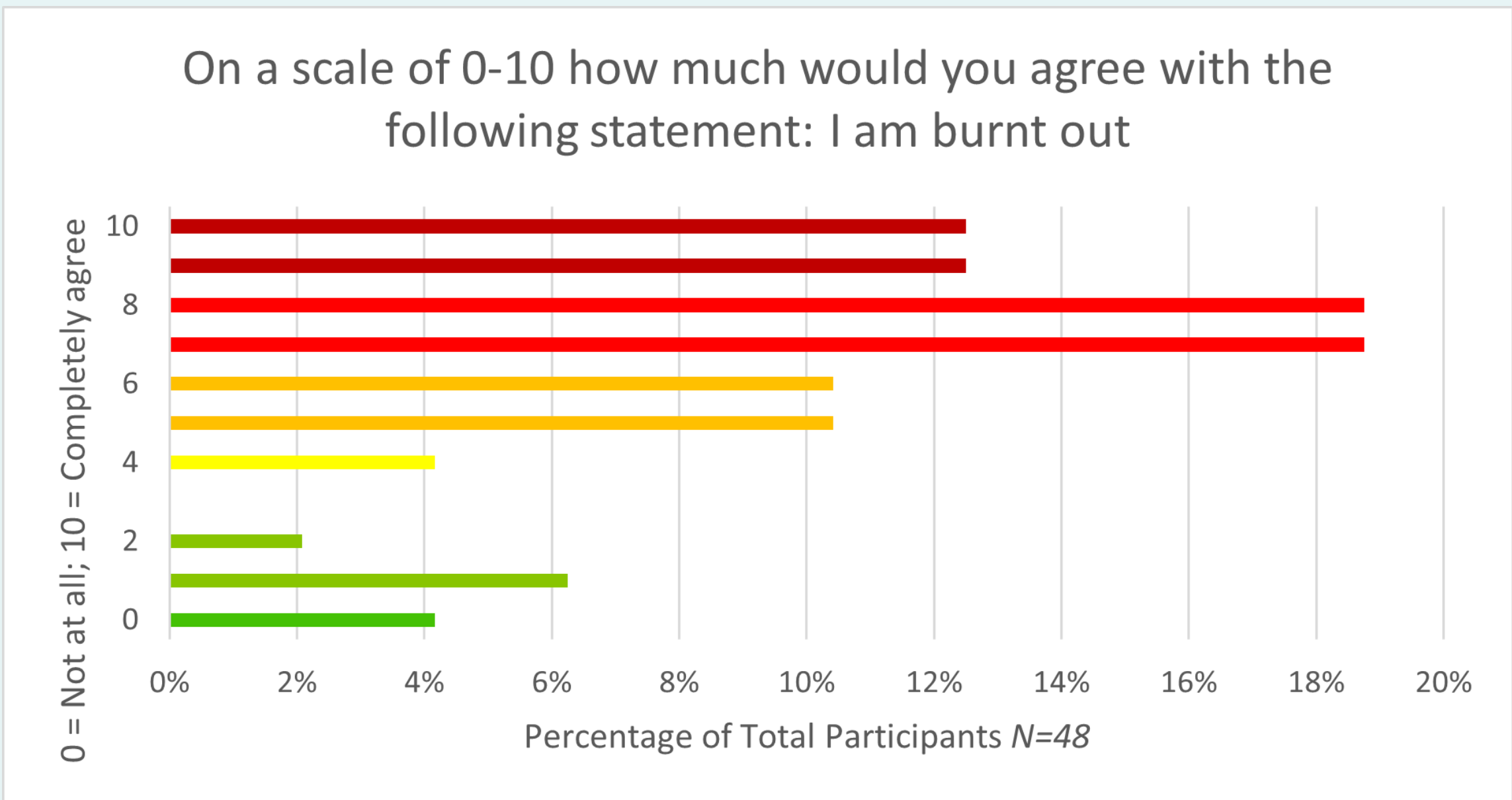
Sampling: Convenience sample

Years of clinical experience		Staff Band		Gender	
>1 year	n=4	Band 5	n=25	Male	n=10
1-5 years	n=22	Band 6	n=14	Female	n=38
>5 years	n=22	Band 7	n=9	Other	n=0



Results

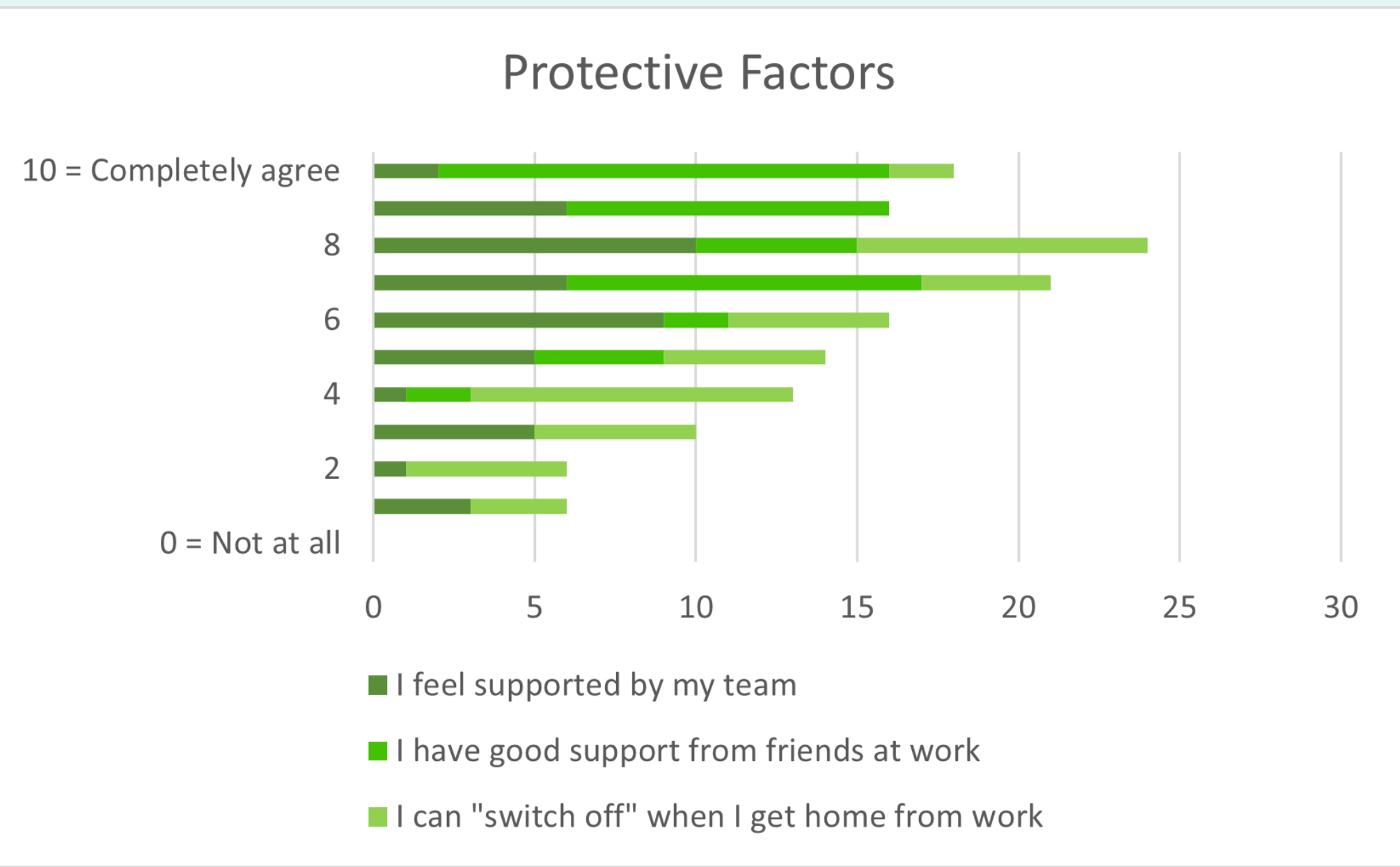
96% of respondents reported feeling burnt out to some degree, of those **87%** of participants moderately to completely agreed with the statement “I am burnt out” (score between 5-10).



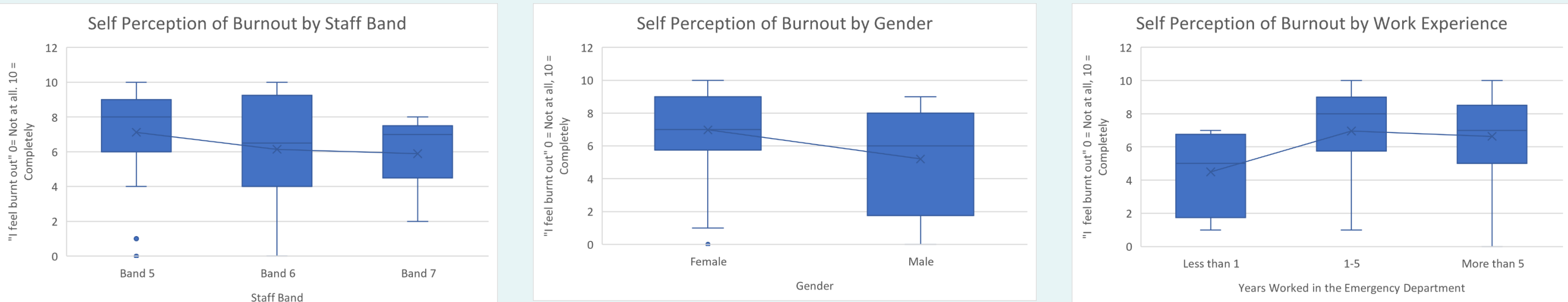
Participants reported frequent feelings of emotional exhaustion, negative feelings towards their work and poor personal efficacy, with 50% of respondents stating they felt exhausted and **50%** completely drained by work **every day** in the last six months.

“...a serious threat to our mental health. It is the main reason so many people are leaving”

Of the protective factors examined, few participants felt supported by their team, however all participants reported feeling supported by friends at work to some extent.



Band 5 and 6 nurses with >1 year experience working within the emergency department were more likely to state they felt burnt out. No male participants completely agreed with the statement “I am burnt out”.



Qualitative analysis of the comments at the end of the survey identified four key themes relating to burnout: feeling **unsupported, unsustainable workload, poor staffing, and low morale.**

Conclusions

Emergency department nurses are indicating high levels of self-perceived burnout, reporting moderate to high levels of emotional exhaustion, negative feelings towards their work, and poor personal efficacy – factors identified as contributors to burnout.

While all the participants indicated experiencing some support in the workplace, most felt more supported by work friends than their team, many reporting difficulty “switching off” after work.

Implications for Practice / Future Research

An abundance of studies have documented the negative impacts of burnout. It is detrimental to nurse performance, mental health, commitment and contributes to already poor staffing levels due to nurses leaving high stress areas.

More intervention is needed to support emergency department nurses at a time when EDs are seeing increasing patient numbers.

Further research is required to explore what organisations / teams can do to mitigate or prevent the effects of burnout in ED nurses post-pandemic.

This study was conducted in only one emergency department in one city, A wider geographical range is suggested.

Relevant Literature

Compassion fatigue, burnout, compassion satisfaction and depression among emergency department physicians and nurses: a cross-sectional study 2022 <https://bmjopen.bmj.com/content/52/4/e005941.full>

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